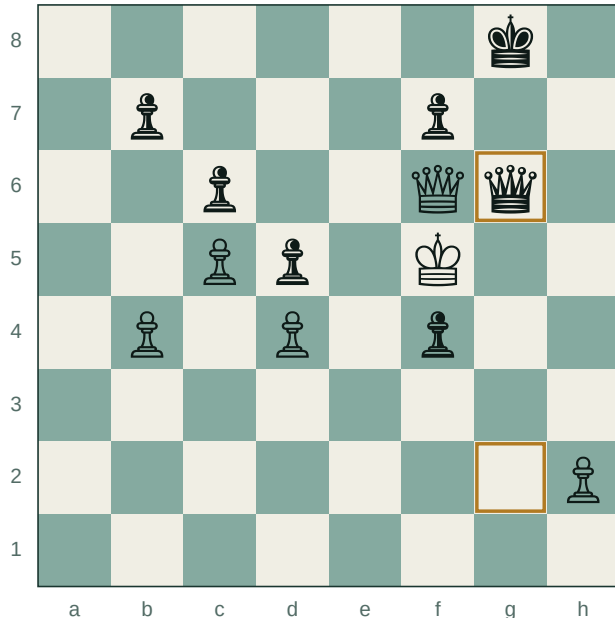


Queen-ending tactics: White, move 38

Queen-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 37...Qg6+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Qxg6+ fxg6+ 39. Kxf4

38.Qxg6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on g6. Recorded reply: **38...fxg6+**.

39.Kxf4 The king captures the pawn on f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.